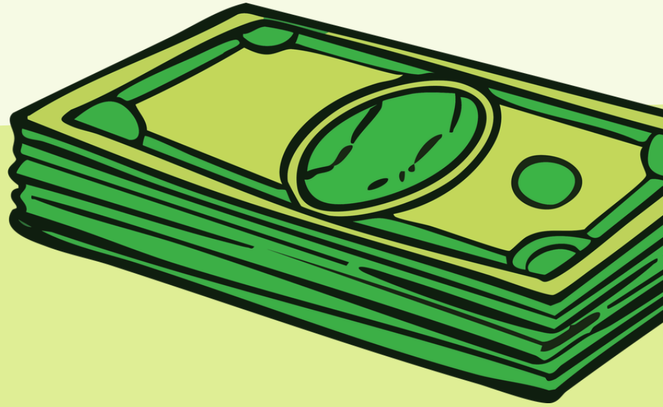




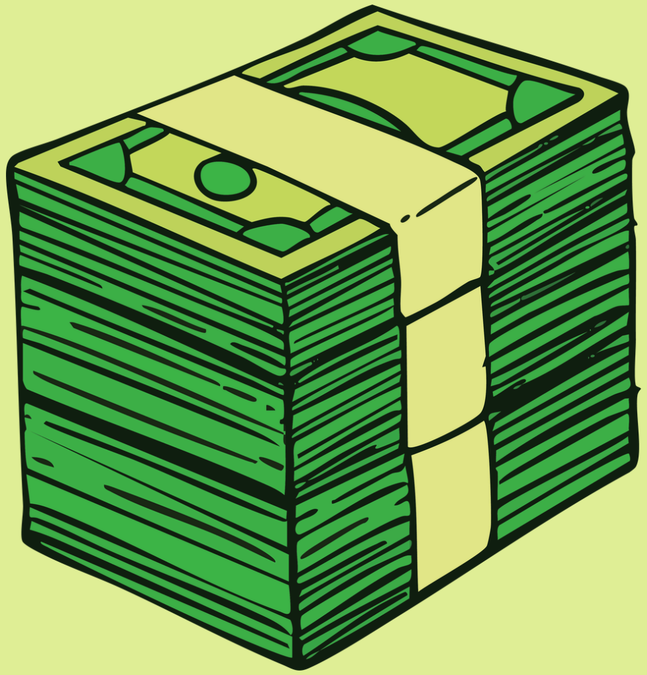
SWOT Analysis

By: Ronan Murphy, Wesley Reed, Jackson Ferrill, Sami Marjane, Jonah Kauffman, Aaron Turner, and Patrick Foerster



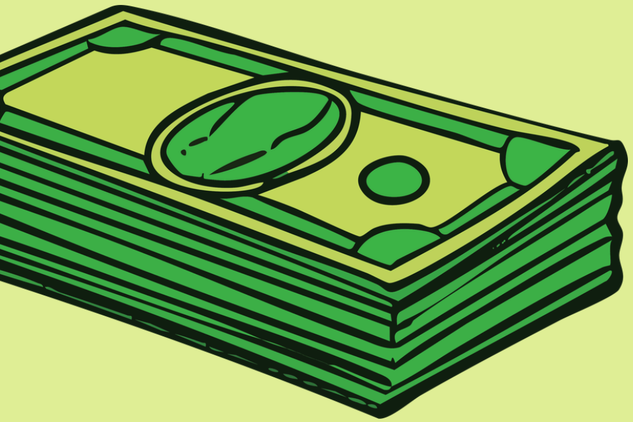


Overview



- In strategic planning and strategic management; SWOT analysis is a decision-making technique
- For an organization or project, it identifies:
  - strengths,
  - weaknesses,
  - opportunities
  - threats

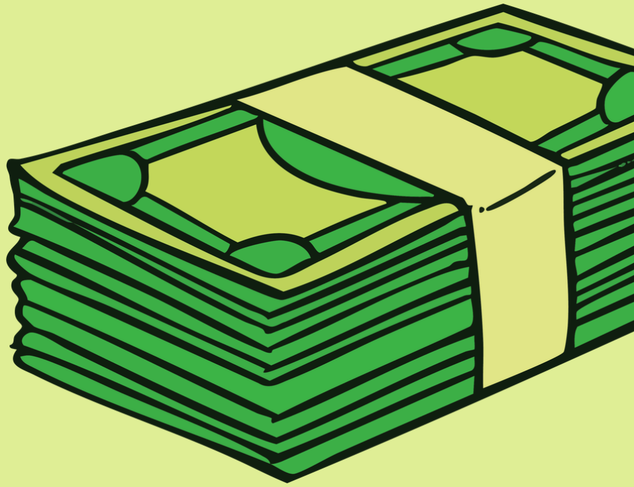
First Quadrant: Strengths



Strengths in the first quadrant are connected on an organizational level which lead to competitive advantage over others.

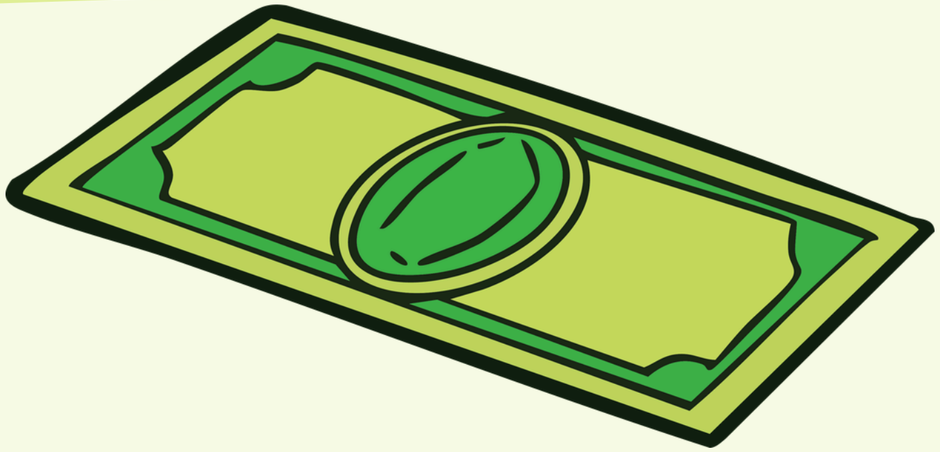
- Internal Positive Attributes
- Resources
- Capabilities

These are come aspects of strengths to combine.



EXAMPLES: Brand & Market Position, Financial & Physical Assets, and Operations & Processes

Second Quadrant: Weaknesses



- Internal Control: Unlike threats, weaknesses originate inside the organization and are theoretically within your power to change or fix
- Performance Barriers: They prevent the business or individual from operating at peak efficiency or seizing available opportunities.



EXAMPLES

- Financial & Capital: High levels of debt, lack of working capital, or tight profit margins.
- Operational & Supply Chain: Inadequate supply chain reliability, outdated technology, or inefficient internal processes.
- Human Resources & Skills: Staff shortages, high employee turnover, or critical skill gaps.

Third Quadrant: Opportunities

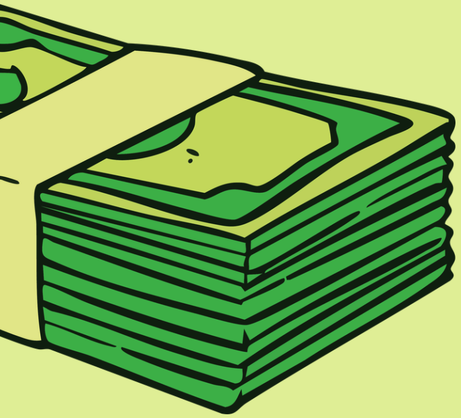
Favorable external conditions or trends that an organization, compony, or individual can leverage to gain a competitive advantage.



Examples:

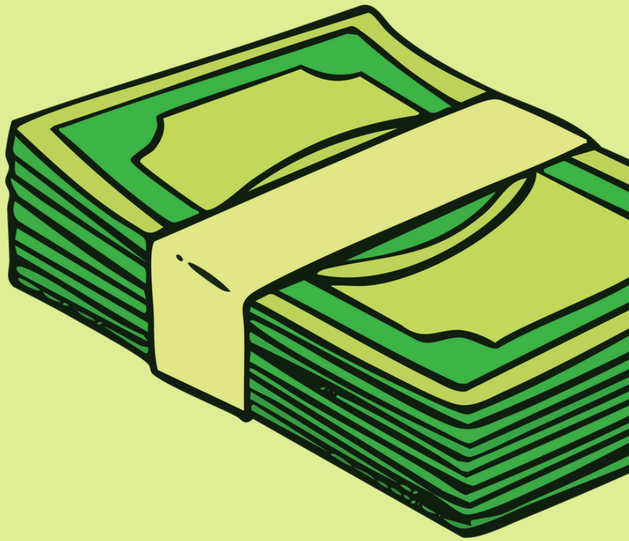
- A government cutting an import tariff allowing a car company to export into the international market.
- Public demand goes up for a type of food allowing a food company to start selling that type of food.

Fourth Quadrant: Threats



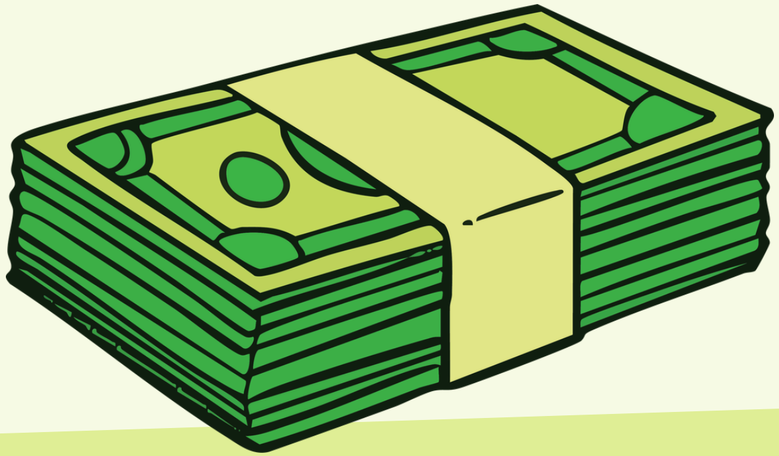
In a SWOT analysis, threats are external, uncontrollable factors that could damage your business, product, or profitability. Unlike strengths and weaknesses (which are internal), threats originate from outside your organization.

Examples: New rivals, rising costs, supply chain disruption, shifting customer preferences



Horzontal Axis: Impact

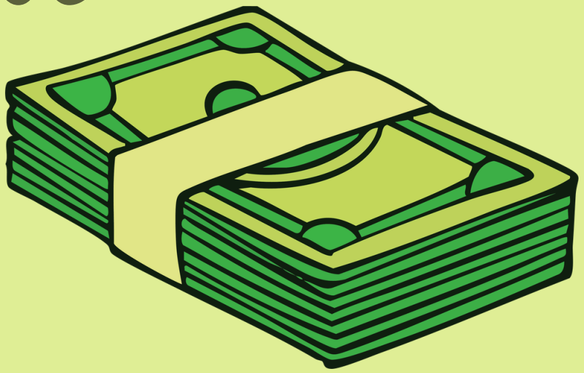




- Impact is whether the category is helpful are harmful to the business
- Strengths and opportunities are considered helpful because they help the company grow
- Weaknesses and threats are considered harmful because they can hinder company growth

Vertical Axis: Origin

- Origin relates to where it comes from
- Strengths and weaknesses fall in internal origin
  - They are considered internal because they originate inside the business and can be controlled by the business
- Opportunities and threats fall in external origin
  - They are considered external because they originate outside the business and can not be controlled by the business





Thank You

